

- acclaim** public praise
accumulate build up over time
accumulation a gradual building up
alleviate make less severe
allocate set aside for a purpose
anguish severe mental pain
annihilation complete destruction
approximation a close but inexact figure
artifact an object made by people, esp. of historical interest
asserts states firmly, without proving it
attrition a gradual wearing away or loss in numbers
authenticity being genuine rather than copied
bleak grim; without hope
brazen boldly shameless
breadth range; how wide something is
bribery paying someone to act dishonestly
caricature an exaggerated portrayal
causality one thing actually causing another
characterize describe the nature of
charisma personal magnetism
cognition thinking and knowing
colonization settling and taking control of a place
comparatively relatively; when set against others
compiling gathering together into one work
conceive form in the mind; imagine
conclusively in a way that settles the matter
condensed made shorter or denser
confine keep within limits
confiscation official seizure of property
conformity going along with what others do
contemporaries people living at the same time
contradictory in conflict with each other
converge come together at a point
conveying getting across; communicating
conveys gets across; communicates
correlated varying together, without proving cause
corresponds matches; answers to
corrupted spoiled; altered for the worse
cultivated grown deliberately; refined
cumulative adding up as it goes
curated selected and arranged by an expert
depict show or represent
depiction a representation of something
detachment being uninvolved; distance
deviation a departure from the usual
disenfranchised deprived of a right, esp. the vote
disparity a marked inequality
displeasure annoyance; disapproval
divergence a moving apart; a difference
domesticated tamed for human use
duplication repeating something unnecessarily
emphasizes gives special weight to
enactment putting a law into force; performing
entails necessarily involves
entrusted given as a responsibility
envision picture in the mind
ephemeral lasting a very short time
ethnographic describing a people and their culture
evasive avoiding a direct answer
evidently apparently; as far as one can see
exhilarating thrilling; invigorating
expansive wide-ranging; extensive
expenditures amounts spent
explanatory serving to explain
expulsion being forced out
exuberant full of lively energy
facets aspects; sides of something
fathom understand after effort
feats impressive achievements
flatter praise beyond what is deserved
flourished thrived; did well
fluency ease and smoothness, esp. in speech
folklore the traditional stories of a people
folly foolishness
fortified strengthened; reinforced
fractured broken; split
framing how something is presented
frivolous not serious; trivial
heightened increased; made more intense
hypothetical supposed for argument, not actual
idiosyncratic peculiar to one person
illumination light; clarification

immobile	unable to move	portrays	depicts; represents
improvisation	making it up as you go	predation	hunting other animals for food
impulsive	acting without thinking first	predecessors	those who came before
inconsistencies	places where things do not agree	predictor	something that indicates what will happen
incorporates	takes in as part of itself	profoundly	deeply; thoroughly
incur	bring upon oneself (a cost, a risk)	prominence	being important or noticeable
indistinguishable	impossible to tell apart	propagated	spread; multiplied
induce	bring about; persuade	proverbs	short traditional sayings
influx	an arrival of many at once	purposeful	done with a clear aim
infrequently	rarely	pursuits	activities one gives time to
inhabit	live in	quaint	attractively old-fashioned
inherently	by its very nature	reckoning	a calculation; a settling of accounts
inhibit	hold back; slow down	reconstruct	build up again from evidence
insightful	showing deep understanding	recounts	tells the story of
interspersed	scattered in among	reflective	thoughtful; throwing back light
intervening	coming in between	regal	royal; magnificent
intuitive	grasped without reasoning it out	relinquish	give up; let go of
inverse	reversed; the opposite way round	reverence	deep respect
keenly	sharply; intensely	scarce	in short supply
lament	express grief over	scarcely	hardly; only just
leisurely	unhurried	seclusion	being kept apart from others
magistrates	local judges or officials	sordid	squalid; morally grubby
manipulating	handling skilfully; controlling unfairly	stagnant	not moving; not developing
mindful	keeping something in mind	stillness	complete quiet and lack of motion
modernist	of the early-20th-century break with tradition	stylistic	to do with style rather than content
monumental	very great; like a monument	stylized	made to follow a convention rather than life
motifs	recurring elements in a work	subdue	bring under control; soften
nonfiction	writing about real events	subset	a smaller group inside a larger one
obedience	doing as one is told	subsistence	having only just enough to live on
observational	based on watching rather than experimenting	symbolism	using things to stand for ideas
obstruction	something blocking the way	tiresome	tedious; wearying
ominous	suggesting something bad is coming	topography	the shape of the land
outnumbered	fewer than the others	trajectory	the path something follows
passively	without acting; letting things happen	troublesome	causing difficulty
pedagogy	the practice of teaching	unifying	bringing together into a whole
pivotal	on which everything turns	unjustified	not supported by good reason
ponder	think over carefully	unrealistic	not matching how things really are
populace	the people of a place	vanquished	defeated utterly
porous	full of tiny holes; letting things through	vigorously	with force and energy
portrayal	the way something is depicted	wayward	wilful; hard to control
		whereupon	at which point
		yielded	produced; gave way